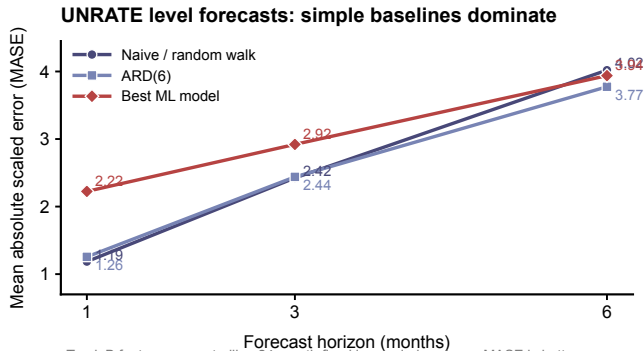


Track B UNRATE: persistence beats richer ML

24-month fixed input window · look-ahead $h \in \{1, 3, 6\}$ months · metric: mean absolute scaled error (MASE)



Track B features use a trailing 24-month fixed input window; lower MASE is better.

Best rows

Best model at each horizon, selected by lowest MASE. Errors are in unemployment-rate percentage points.

Target	h	Model	RMSE	MAE	MASE	n
UNRATE	1	Naive / Random Walk	0.511	0.153	1.185	516
UNRATE	3	Naive / Random Walk	0.865	0.313	2.424	516
UNRATE	6	ARD(6)	1.398	0.486	3.774	516

Interpretation.

UNRATE levels are highly persistent. With interpretable Track B inputs, richer ML models do not beat the naive/ARD baselines.

Track B: UNRATE level/delta, building permits, S&P 500, consumer sentiment, and 10Y-3M yield spread level/delta.